BEFORE DECIDING WHETHER SOLAR MAKES SENSE

Look at What You Are Paying for Now and the Cost of Not Changing

A household electric bill reflects more than the electricity used inside one home. It is connected to a vast system that must generate, move, balance, protect, store, and reliably deliver power as California's needs change.



Every monthly bill pays for more than the electricity used inside one home.
It also reflects the shared system that produces, moves, protects, balances, and delivers electricity, along with the continuing work required to keep that system dependable.

What you pay for | Rates vs inflation | Changing demand | Long-term view | Household impact | The movement | Share

01

THE BIG PICTURE

What Drives Electricity Costs?

The complete picture is more complex than one company choosing a price.

Electricity prices reflect a system that must be ready before a switch is flipped. The bill supports energy production, networks, equipment, labor, planning, protection, financing, and reserve capability.

Explore the cost drivers →

- Growing and changing energy demand +
- Aging infrastructure +
- Wildfire prevention and system hardening +
- Renewable-energy transition, transmission and storage +
- Reliability requirements +

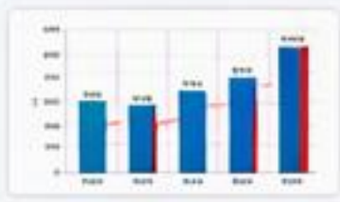
02

HISTORICAL PERSPECTIVE

Using the Same Amount of Electricity Does Not Guarantee Paying the Same Amount

Household usage matters, but the price applied to that usage is shaped by the cost of operating, protecting, financing, and changing the larger system.

See the data on rates vs. inflation →



California Electricity Costs Have Risen Faster Than General Inflation +

A decade of change.

03

A CHANGING CALIFORNIA

Electricity Is Becoming More Important

A generation ago, electricity primarily powered lights and appliances. Today it increasingly supports transportation, home comfort, work, internet connectivity, security, digital services, and more.

Explore the key trends →


California EV adoption has accelerated +


How the vehicle fleet is changing +


Who is driving future electricity demand? +

04

YOUR HOUSEHOLD

The Cost of Electricity Affects More Than Electricity

When an essential recurring expense rises, it competes with other uses of income.

See the bigger impact →

Retirement and Fixed Income | Working and Young Families | Homeowners and Renters | Small Businesses

A REAL QUESTION

Do I want to remain completely exposed to future electricity costs, or do I want some level of control over them?

The cost of not changing is not one predictable number. It is continued exposure to future electricity purchases, prices, and rate structures while electricity becomes increasingly important to daily life.

THE INFORMED HOMEOWNER MOVEMENT

Awareness Should Be Shared, Not Sold

The Informed Homeowner Movement is a simple idea: Californians should help one another understand the costs, risks, contracts, assumptions, and long-term choices connected to home energy.



01 Better Information
Use verifiable sources, explain measurements, separate history from estimates or projections, and disclose limitations.

02 Better Questions
Ask what a number includes, who produced it, how it was calculated, and whether it matches the complete household experience.

03 Better Decisions
Respect that every household is different. Information should expand thoughtful choices, not pressure everyone into one answer.

What the movement stands for +

What the movement does not stand for +

HELP ONE MORE PERSON BECOME INFORMED

If This Information Helped You, Share It Before Someone You Care About Needs It

Many people do not think about energy costs until they become a problem.
Awareness costs nothing. Waiting can be expensive.
Not to alarm them. Not to sell them something. To help them ask better questions while meaningful choices are still available.

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THE CLOSING THOUGHT

The Goal Is Not Fear. The Goal Is Foresight.

No chart can tell anyone exactly what electricity will cost in 10 or 20 years. History can show what has changed. Current adoption and consumption patterns can show how electricity's role is expanding. Each household can then decide whether continuing without a long-term energy-cost plan is a risk it is comfortable accepting.

The question is no longer only:
"How much is my electric bill today?"

The larger question may be:
"How will electricity affect my household finances over the next 20 years?"

Better information. Better questions. Better decisions.

SOURCES & METHODOLOGY

Explore the data, measurement standards, and sources used on this page.

How to read the visual evidence + | Minimum requirements for every chart + | Editorial standard +

Core public sources +